

Signing of MoU's with Apex Organizations & Capacity Building of Khadi Artisans

Khadi has also signed five MOUs for the creation of the **'New Khadi for New India'** through modernization and promotion of Khadi. These strategic MoUs are with apex organizations such as Prasar Bharati, NBCC (India) Limited, Digital India Corporation, National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT) and Quality Council of India (QCI). Aligned with the vision of PM Modi for 'Vocal for Local' and 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat,' these MOUs aim to modernize KVIC and promote its products among the youth. KVIC has also set up a Centre of Excellence for Khadi (COEK) together with National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT) to upgrade and modernize heritage crafts and provide expert advice on technical specifications of new and modern designs, new Khadi products etc.

This centre has been set up on the Hub and Spoke model with NIFT New Delhi as Hub along with NIFT Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Kolkata and Shillong- for establishing benchmarked design processes for global standards, creating new fabrics and products and disseminating quality standards for fabrics. KVIC is also conducting programs for skill enhancement of Khadi artisans and Khadi workers through various capacity building programs like inventory, production and quality management, pattern making and garment making, visual merchandising etc. to adopt latest machinery and technology. Similarly, new Central sliver Plants (CSP) are being set up, renovated and modernized to improve quality and increase productivity and reduce roving cost.

Achievements of PM Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP)

Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC), is also implementing the flagship scheme of Ministry of MSME, Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) for assisting entrepreneurs in setting up of new units in the non-farm sector. It aims to provide employment opportunities to traditional artisans/ rural and urban unemployed youth at their doorstep. Since its inception, the scheme has been a driving force in fostering entrepreneurship and creating job opportunities across the nation. This scheme fulfils the dream of **'becoming a job provider rather than a job seeker'**. Under the scheme more than 9 lakh new projects have been established, showcasing a robust growth in entrepreneurial ventures. With a primary focus on job creation, PMEGP has successfully generated employment for over 78 lakh individuals, contributing significantly to the country's workforce.

In the past financial year alone, the scheme provided employment to more than 9.37 lakh individuals, reflecting its sustained impact on the job market. The financial support provided through PMEGP is evident in the distribution of margin money subsidies exceeding ₹23,000 crores. This subsidy has been instrumental in enabling aspiring entrepreneurs to kickstart their ventures. The Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) continues to be a catalyst for economic growth, empowering individuals to become self-reliant and contributing to the overall development of the Nation. As the program progresses, it continues to play a vital role in the socio-economic landscape, aligning with the government's vision for a self-sufficient and thriving India.

New Schemes of KVIC : Khadi Vikas Yojana (KVY) and Gramodyog Vikas Yojana (GVY)

In order to promote and support the Khadi sector, KVIC has taken a number of initiatives to revive, modernize and boost sales of the Khadi sector. These include augmentation of **'Khadi Vikas Yojana (KVY)'** to increase the production and sale of Khadi products. Under the scheme, assistance is provided under four major components, the first one being **Interest Subsidy Eligibility Certificate (ISEC)** Scheme providing credit at concessional rate of interest of just 4% to Khadi Institutions (KIs) through banks with KVIC covering the interest charged by banks beyond the 4% threshold, ensuring enhanced financial assistance. Under the second component i.e., **'Strengthening Infrastructure of existing weak Khadi Institutions and Assistance for Marketing Infrastructure',** financial assistance is provided to existing weak Khadi Institutions for strengthening their infrastructure and for renovation of Khadi sales outlets. Financial assistance of up to Rs.15.00 lakh is now provided for capital expenditure and working capital to Khadi institutions instead of earlier Rs.9.90 lakh.

Under the third component of **'Workshed Scheme for Khadi Artisans',** assistance is provided for construction of individual as well as group workshed for better work environment. A financial assistance of up to Rs.1,20,000 is now being provided for construction of individual worksheds instead of earlier Rs.60,000 and Rs.80,000 per